AA-F-367
AUGUST 20, 1956
SUPERSEDING IN PART
Fed. Spec. AA-F-791b
October 25, 1937

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILING CABINET, STEEL, TABULATING MACHINE CARD SIZE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 **Scope.** — This specification covers a tabulating-machine-card steel filing cabinet for the filing and finding of active machine card records

1.2 **Classification.**

1.2.1 *Type* —The filing cabinet covered by this specification shall be of but one type: 11 drawers, 22 trays, and full suspension

1.2.2 *Color of finish.* — The color of the finish shall be as specified and shall match the following standard colors of finish adopted by the Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration (see 6.2a).

Gray
Olive green

(Sample panels of the standard colors of finish are obtainable without charge from the Business Service Center Regional Office Building Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington 25, D. C. or from the Business Service Center of the nearest GSA Regional Office.)

2 APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications

G-C-116—Cards, Tabulating
TT-E-529 — Enamel, Synthetic, Semi-Gloss
UU-P-270 — Paper, Wrapping, Waxed (Dry)
LLL-B-631—Boxes, Fiber, Corrugated (For Domestic Shipment).
LLL-B-636—Boxes, Fiber, Solid (For Domestic Shipment)
PPP-B-585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound
PPP-B-601—Boxes Wood, Cleated-Plywood

Military Specifications

JAN-P-106 — Boxes, Wood, Nailed (Overseas Type).
JAN-P-108 — Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid (Military Type).
MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.
JAN-P-127 — Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment — Tape, Adhesive Pressure-Sensitive, Water-Resistant
MIL-C-496—Cleaning and Preparation of Ferrous and Zinc-Coated Surfaces For Organic Protective Coatings
MIL-B-10377 — Boxes Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

FSC Class 7110

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

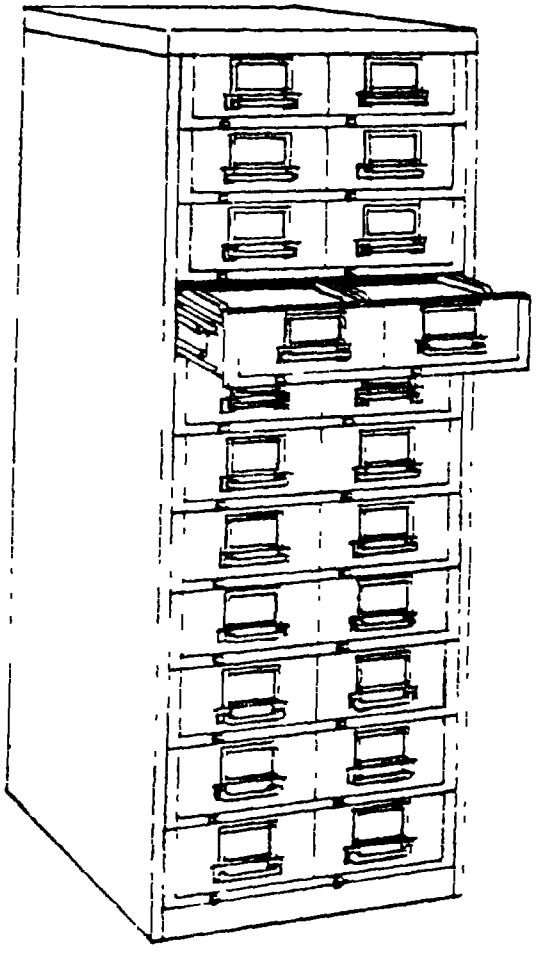


FIGURE 1

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standards

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables For Inspection By Attributes

MIL-STD-129—Marking For Shipment and Storage

MIL-STD-130 — Identification Marking for U S Military Property

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under "General Information" and at the prices indicated in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents U S Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D C

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by nongovernmental activities for bidding purposes are available without charge at the GSA Regional Offices in Boston, New York Atlanta, Chicago Kansas City Missouri Dallas Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D C

(Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications** — The following publication of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids forms a part of this specification

Consolidated Classification Committee Publication

Consolidated Freight Classification Rules

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee 202 Chicago Union Station Chicago 6 Illinois

3 REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Component parts.—The filing cabinet shall consist of a cabinet, drawers, drawer suspensions, removable trays, locking devices, and miscellaneous hardware

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 *Sheet steel* —Sheet steel used for exposed surfaces of the filing cabinet shall be open hearth, pickled, cold rolled, stretcher leveled, and oiled Unexposed parts shall be made of cold- or hot-rolled steel The gage numbers specified are the Manufacturers' Standard Gage for Steel Sheets and the nominal thicknesses shown are subject to the established tolerances or ordering limits.

3.2.2 *Nonferrous metals* — Nonferrous metals shall be of the quality currently used commercially by the steel office-furniture industry.

3.3 Design and construction —The filing cabinet shall be designed similar to figure 1 and constructed to contain 22 removable trays, 2 trays wide by 11 trays high Each set of two side-by-side trays shall be mounted on a tray carriage or drawer which shall be carried by a full suspension

3.3.1 *Storage capacity* —The filing cabinet shall have a net filing capacity of not less than 82,000 tabulating machine cards conforming to Federal Specification G-C-116, size 3¼ by 7⅞ inches (Capacity shall be figured at the rate of 150 cards per inch for each inch of net clear filing space)

3 4 Serviceability.—Each loaded drawer of the filing cabinet shall be capable of withstanding 50,000 cycles of opening and closing The cards shall not be damaged during normal use nor spill out when a tray is overturned

3.4.1 *Durability of finish.* — The enamel finish specified in 3.7.1 shall not crack or chip when the sheet steel on which it is painted is tested in accordance with 4.2.1.3.3

3.5 Details of components.

3.5.1 *Cabinet.*—The dimensions of the cabinet shall be as specified in table I.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I.—*Dimensions*

	Case, outside			Tray, inside clear		
	Width	Height	*Inches*	Width	Height	Depth (net)
	Inches	*Inches*	28½	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
Maximum	20½	52½	Depth			
Minimum	19	51	28	7½	35½	25¾

3.5.1.1 *Inner frame*.—The cabinet inner frame shall have two front, two rear, and two intermediate uprights. The front uprights shall be made of steel 0.0478 inch thick and the intermediate and rear uprights shall be made of steel 0.0359 inch thick. The reinforcing braces and the top, bottom, and drawer separators shall be of steel 0.0598 inch thick. The inner frame shall be fully welded, braced, and interlocked to form a rigid case. Steel shall be as specified in 3.2.1.

3.5.1.2 *Exterior*.—The top, bottom, and side panels of the cabinet shall be of steel 0.0359 inch thick extending the full width and depth of the cabinet. The bottom base shall be the fully-enclosed pan type. The back panel shall be of steel not less than 0.0299 inch thick. The steel shall be as specified in 3.2.1. All joints shall be closed and smooth.

3.5.2 *Drawer (tray carriage)*.—The steel drawer shall be of rigid construction and capable of supporting two fully-loaded removable trays without distortion, play or sag which would interfere with efficient lifetime operation. The drawer shall be mounted on full-length progressive suspension arms which shall support the drawer to clear its full length without visible deflection. The drawer shall be of open-front design with rigid corner posts, and it shall be possible to replace a tray with the drawer closed. Steel nominal thicknesses of the drawer sections shall range from 0.0299 to 0.0747 inch, depending on design, to meet serviceability requirements.

3.5.2.1 *Drawer safety device*.—The drawer shall have a safety device to prevent it from falling when fully extended, and a latch, conveniently located near each tray pull, that will prevent the drawer from opening except upon release of the latch.

3.5.3 *Drawer suspensions*.—The drawer suspensions shall be the full progressive type equivalent in materials as well as assembly and finish to those specified herein, and shall pass the test specified in 4.2.1.3.1. Suspension channels shall be cold drawn from cold-rolled steel, electrogalvanized for rust-resistance and cadmium nickel, zinc, or chrome plated, or treated by a phosphoric acid process and finished with a hard-baked nonchipping enamel. The suspensions shall be either the side-arm or cradle type. When journaled rollers are used, each suspension shall have at least six journaled rollers of the ball-bearing type. Where free rollers or balls are used, they shall be at least ⅝ inch in diameter, hardened and polished and retained in concave races to prevent dislocation or removal unless the suspension is dismantled. Rollers shall be turned from cold-rolled steel and case hardened.

3.5.3.1 *Suspension components*.

3.5.3.1.1 *Case channels*.—There shall be two case channels per drawer. The channels shall be made of 0.0747- to 0.0897-inch-thick steel, hardened to a Rockwell hardness of 70-80 on the B scale, and attached to a supporting channel at least 0.0598 inch thick. The supporting channel shall back and reinforce the case channels and permit them to

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

be attached to the front and rear case uprights. The case channels shall be easily removable and replaceable.

3.5.3.1.2 *Intermediate channels* — There shall be at least two intermediate channels per drawer. The intermediate channels shall be made of steel 0.0747 to 0.0897 inch thick. There shall be no excessive noise or shock when the drawers are used.

3.5.3.1.3 *Bumpers* — Suspensions shall have bumpers to absorb the shock when the drawers are opened and closed.

3.5.4 *Removable trays* —The trays shall be designed to carry and protect the cards. The trays shall be removable without lifting over the drawer sides and shall be returnable without fully extending the drawer. The trays shall be of box-type design with the front made of inner and outer head and with sides rigidly formed into a track for carrying a compressor block. Assembly shall be by welding. The outer and inner heads, drawer sides, and bottom shall be of steel 0.0299 inch thick. The back shall be of steel 0.0478 inch thick and shall be provided with a strong, comfortable handhole, amply reinforced and buffed smooth. All trays shall have rolled edges and shall be formed and assembled for hard usage. All rough edges, joints, and surfaces shall be eliminated. Trays shall be capable of being stacked without injury to the cards.

3.5.4.1 *Tray compressor* —Each tray shall have one positive-locking compressor. The compressor shall remain vertical and the compressor plate shall not mar the cards. The compressor shall pass the test specified in 4.2.1.3.2.

3.5.4.2 *Tray and drawer identification* — Trays and drawers shall have ample identification for proper replacement of each tray in the cabinet after use. Any suitable means of identification such as decals, labels, or numbers (1 to 22) may be used on the inside front of the drawer. All trays shall be interchangeable in the cabinet.

3.5.5 *Locking device.*—When specified, a general locking device shall be provided (see 6.2). The locking device shall consist of the following:

a. A lockbar that moves vertically in a groove in the right-hand front upright, guided by a drawer spacer, gussets, and suspension case channel supports.

b. A cam attached to a plunger-type lock (paracentric key) in the right-hand top corner of the case pilaster to control the vertical movement of the lockbar.

3.5.5.1 When the lock is pressed in, the bar shall move into the locked position. To unlock, the key shall be turned one-fourth turn clockwise. The lockbar shall be punched at suitable intervals for automatic-lock catches. Catches shall be made of approximately 0.0897-inch-thick steel and shall be bolted to the lockbar. It shall be possible to install a general locking device in the field.

3.5.6 *Miscellaneous hardware* — No stamped hardware shall be permitted.

3.5.6.1 *Label holders* — Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), label holders shall be of satin-finished anodized aluminum. The holders shall hold a card not less than 2 by 3 inches in size. The holder frame shall be smooth with rounded corners and shall be attached to the tray front with concealed fasteners.

3.5.6.2 *Drawer pulls* — Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), drawer pulls shall be of satin-finished anodized aluminum. The size of the handhole shall be not less than 3 by 7/8 inches.

3.5.6.3 *Drawer release knob* —One release knob or latch, conveniently located near each tray pull, shall be provided in the front of each drawer. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the knob shall be of satin-finished anodized aluminum.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.6 Interchangeability.—All parts having he same manufacturer's part number shall e directly and completely interchangeable ith each other with respect to installation nd performance

3 7 **Finish** —All meta' parts except finished ardware, shal be cleaned and treated in ccordance with any grades or types specified - Military Specification MIL–C–490

3 7 1 *Enamel* — All stee' parts shall be ainted with ename conforming to Federal pecification TT–E–529, class B, or equiva- nt All enamel coatings shal' be baked for t least 45 minutes at 300°F or in accordance itr the enamel manufacturer s recom- endations The enamel surface shall be not ss than 1 mil thick and shall comply with 4 1

3.8 Identification of product —Wher spec- ed, equipment assemb ies, and parts shal. e marked for identification in accordance ith Military Standard MIL–STD–130

3.9 **Workmanship**

3 9.1 *General* —The filing cabinet includ- g al' parts and accessories shal be fab- cated and finished in a workmanlike man- -r Particular attention shall be given to eedom from blemishes, defects burrs, and harp edges accuracy of moving parts, di- ensions and marking of parts and assem- ies, thoroughness of welding brazing, eaning painting and riveting alignment parts and tightness of assembly screws nd bolts

3 9.2 *Riveting* —Riveting operations sha carefully performed to insure tight and tisfactory heading of rivets

3.9.3 *Cleaning* —The filing cabinet shal be horoughly cleaned and loose meta chips and her foreign materia removed during and ter final assembly

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST ROCEDURES

4.1 Classification of tests.—The inspection id testing of filing cabinets shall be classi- d as acceptance tests

4.2 Acceptance tests —Acceptance tests shall consist of the sampling plans and tests

4 2 1 *Sampling plans and tests*

4 2.1 1 *Lot* —The lot definition formation, and size shall be in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105

4 2.1.1.1 *Military Standard MIL–STD–105* —Wher Military Standard MIL–STD–105 specifies an action by the Government, it shall at the option of the Government, be performed either by the Government or by the contractor under the supervision of the Government inspector

4.2.1.2 *Examination of product* — Each sample filing cabinet shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified herein with respect to details of construction, materials hardware, finish, dimensions, marking, and workmanship

4.2 1.3 *Sampling tests* —One cabinet shall be taken at random from each lot of 100 or fraction thereof produced and subjected to the following tests

4 2 1 3 1 *Capacity load test* —Each tray of the drawer taken for testing shall be loaded to capacity The cabinet shall be bolted or otherwise secured in position and connected to a test machine which will operate the test drawer or its suspension There shall be a means for adjusting the length of its stroke so that the drawer will trave the full distance from back stop to front stop (minus ¼ inch) and a test method to drive the drawer at a rate not exceeding 20 cpm but not in any way contribute to the support of the drawer The suspension shall be cleaned and lubricated at the end of 10 000 cycles and shall have no further attention until the test is completed At the beginning of the test and at each increment of 10,000 cycles, a test shall be conducted to determine the force required to start the loaded drawer moving forward and to move it to its full outward limit This part of the test shall be conducted

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

by passing a limp cord, tied to the center of the drawer pull, over a sheave with weight applied to its free end The drawer suspension shall be considered as having failed the test if the drawer operating force exceeds $3^3/_4$ pounds to complete the forward stroke before or at 50,000 cycles Should failure be perceptible during the increments of 10,000 cycles the apparatus shall be stopped and the load test concluded at that point and the cabinets shall be considered as having failed to meet the test

4 2.1.3 2 *Compressor test* —Each tray shall be loaded with 16 inches of cards The compressor shall be tightly positioned to press against the cards The tray shall be turned upside down and the cards shall remain in their original position

4 2 1.3.3 *Adhesion and flexibility test* — The adhesion and flexibility of the applied ename shall be checked by bending a test specimen 180 around a $^1/_4$-inch rod at room temperature There shall be no injury to the ename.

5 PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5 1 Levels of preservation and packaging

5.1 1 *Level A—for overseas shipment and domestic shipment with more than 180 days storage*

5.1.1 1 *Preservation* — Filing cabinets shall be preserved in accordance with Military Specification MIL–P–116 method II

5 1.1.2 *Unit packaging* — Filing cabinets shall be wrapped in wax paper conforming to Federal Specification UU–P–270 packed with suitable fiberboard packing excelsior pads or other suitable materia and packaged in a fiberboard box conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–108 For domestic shipment containers shall conform to Federal Specification LLL–B–631 or LLL–B–636

5.1.2 *Level C—for domestic shipment with immediate use at initial destination* —Filing cabinets shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice

5.2 Levels of packing.

5.2.1 *Level A—overseas shipment* —Filing cabinets, preserved and packaged as specified in 5 1 1 1 and 5 1 1 2, shall be packed in exterior-type shipping containers conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–585, PPP–B–601, Military Specification JAN–P–106 or MIL–B–10377, respectively Containers shall be closed or strapped in accordance with the applicable container specification or appendix thereto Containers, except those conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–108, shall be provided with a case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547 and shall be sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto As an alternate method containers conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–108 may be sealed at all joints and seams including manufacturer's joint, with tape conforming to Military Specification JAN–P–127

5 2 2 *Level B—domestic shipment* —Filing cabinets preserved and packaged as specified in 5 1 1 1 and 5 1.1 2, may be shipped as unit packages no overpacking being required

5.2.3 *Level C—for domestic shipment with immediate use at initial destination* —Filing cabinets shall be prepared for shipment in a manner that will insure safe transportation, at the lowest rate to the point of delivery Containers shall meet Consolidated Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other common carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation

5.3 **Marking** —Interior and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use** —The filing cabinets covered by this specification are intended to be used for the filing and finding of active tabulating-machine-card records but not for the storage of such records.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currenversion before use.

2 **Ordering data.**—Procurement docu- ts should specify the following:

a Color of enamel. (See 1.2.2.)

b When a general locking device is re- ed. (See 3.5.5.)

c Material for label holders, drawer s, and drawer release knob if other than ified (See 3.5 6.1, 3.5.6.2, and 3.5 6.3)

d Level of packaging and packing re- ed (See section 5.)

tant notice —When Government drawings, speci- ons, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility, nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise, as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q
Navy—*MC* Y
Air Force

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:40Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.